

REBELLION

**A Trick-Taking Card Game for Three to Seven Players, Inspired by
*Blake's 7***

Version 2.0

THE SETTING

In this setting, humanity lives under a single galaxy-spanning government: the Terran Federation. It presents itself as civilization's protector, but it is not altruistic — in practice, it's an empire that controls and dominates every world under its reach, holding power through surveillance, conditioning, and force where persuasion fails. Its authority runs through Supreme Commander Servalan, ruthless and ambitious, backed by enforcers like Travis and the full weight of Space Command.

Scattered resistance movements push back wherever they can find a foothold. The most famous gathers around a man named Blake — a small, mismatched crew of escaped prisoners and reluctant allies that history affectionately remembers as *Blake's 7*.

Somewhere on the edge of Federation space, crews scramble for survival. Every card played is a choice: rescue your people, dodge the Federation's notice, and pray nobody triggers the destruction of Star One before you're ready for it.

If you're new to the show: Star One is the Federation's central communications and control nexus — the single installation that holds its entire administration together. Its location is one of the best-kept secrets in the galaxy; not even the Federation's own command structure knows exactly where it is. That secrecy is exactly why the Reserve matters here. As long as nobody's dealt with it, Star One stays buried, which works in the rebellion's favor — but it also means nobody's actually defending it. Its location only becomes critical the moment something far worse than the Federation comes looking.

PLAYERS & EQUIPMENT

- **Players:** Three to seven. See *The Deal*, below, for sizing.
 - **Equipment:** One standard 52-card deck **plus one Joker** (53 cards total — see *The Wild Card*, below). Pencil and paper for scoring.
 - **Deal:** Clockwise. Rotates one seat to the left after each Mission (hand).
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THE FACTIONS (Suit Meanings)

Suit	Faction	In Play
♥ Hearts	The Crew of the Liberator	Good — capture these for points
♦ Diamonds	Technology	Useful — small points plus a one-time power
♣ Clubs	Hazards	Bad — small penalties plus complications
♠ Spades	Federation Forces	Very bad — avoid capturing these

THE WILD CARD — VILA RESTAL

The Joker represents **Vila**, a Delta grade thief who plays by his own rules.

- **Points:** +10 if captured.
- **Wild play:** Vila may be played to any trick at any time, even when you could have followed the suit led. He never has to follow suit himself.
- **He cannot win a trick.** A wild card played off-suit doesn't compete for highest card; it simply rides along and goes wherever the trick

goes.

- **Power, on capture — "Pick the Lock":** Look through the hand of any one opponent, and take any one card from it. In exchange, give that opponent one card of your choice from your own hand.

Because Vila can be slipped into any trick, he's a handy way to bury a card you don't want to hold onto a moment longer — but playing him does cost you a turn you could've spent following suit normally, so use him with intent.

CARD VALUES & SPECIAL POWERS

Aces rank high in every suit for the purpose of winning a trick. Point values are as follows:

♥ Hearts — The Crew (capture for points)

Card	Points
2-9	Face value (+2 to +9)
10 — Gan	+10
J — Cally	+10
Q — Jenna Stannis	+10
K — Blake	+10
A — Avon	+10 — combined with any Hearts face card in your Capture Pile, triggers The Full Crew . See <i>Star One: Reserve Powers</i> , below.

All seven of the Liberator's original crew are accounted for somewhere in the cards: Blake, Avon, Jenna, Cally, and Gan in Hearts, Vila as the Joker, and Zen as the King of Diamonds.

♠ Spades — Federation Forces (avoid capturing)

Card	Points	Notes
2-9	Face value (-2 to -9)	
10 — Anna Grant	-10	
J — Mutoid	-10	She needs a biochemical serum to survive and draws it through the needle in her own arm. At scoring , she devours one Heart card of your choice from your own Capture Pile — its points don't count this Mission, no matter what. This is mandatory if you hold any Hearts. If your Capture Pile has no Hearts in it, there's nothing for her to take, and no further effect occurs.
Q — Section Leader	-10	
K — Travis	-10	Forces you to seize the Reserve. See <i>Star One: Reserve Powers</i> , below. <i>"I'm done with humanity, and I'm done with the Federation — since they're both done with me."</i>
A — Servalan	-10	Whoever captures this card must immediately lay their hand face-up on the table for the rest of the Mission. They still play normally — but everyone can now see and plan around their cards.

♦ Diamonds — Technology (small reward, plus a power)

Card	Points	Power, triggered the instant you capture it
2-9	+1 each	None
10 — IMIPAK	+1	At scoring , if another 10 (Gan, Dayna Mellanby, or Anna Grant) is also sitting in your Capture Pile, you may assassinate one card of your choice from any player's Capture Pile, including your own — it and its points are cancelled. Entirely optional.
J — Teleport Bracelet	+5	On capture, immediately: swap one card from your hand with one card from your own Capture Pile.
Q — <i>Liberator</i>	+5	On capture, immediately: you may Destroy Star One — see <i>Star One: Reserve Powers</i> , below.
K — Zen	+5	On capture, immediately: look through the hand of any one opponent (information only — take nothing).
A — Orac	+5	On capture, immediately: cancel the point value of one Spade or Club card already sitting in your Capture Pile (it scores 0 instead). This must be used right then, if at all — it cannot be saved for later, and it can only affect a card you've already captured at that moment, not one you capture afterward. Usable once per Mission.

♣ Clubs — Hazards (small penalty)

Card	Points	Notes
2-9	-1 each	

Card	Points	Notes
10 — Dayna Mellanby	+10	The lone bright spot in this suit: Dayna trusts a good blade or a charge of plastic explosive more than she trusts most Federation tech, and that taste for older, hands-on weapons is exactly why she's filed here among the Hazards — even though capturing her is genuinely good for you.
J — System Failure	−5	
Q — Asteroid Field	−5	
K — Carnell, the Psycho-Strategist	−5	Paired with Servalan (Ace of Spades), triggers The Psycho-Strategist's Gambit — see <i>Scoring</i> , below.
A — Star One	−5	Capturing this card ends the Mission immediately. See "Ending a Mission Early" below.

OBJECT OF THE GAME

Score the most points over a number of Missions equal to the number of players (so the deal comes back around to everyone once). Highest cumulative total wins and is named **Commander of the Liberator**.

CHOOSING THE FIRST DEALER

This is a dystopian society — the burden falls on whoever drew the worst luck. Shuffle the deck and have every player draw one card, then return it to the deck and reshuffle before the real deal. Compare what you drew against the Card Values table above: whoever drew the lowest

value — the most negative card at the table — deals the first Mission.
Tied for lowest? Just those players draw again.

THE DEAL

The 53-card deck (52 + Vila) doesn't divide evenly among most player counts, so a handful of cards always get set aside as Star One — the Reserve — to make the rest come out even.

Shuffle thoroughly, then set aside that many cards face-down in the center of the table as Star One, using the table below for your group size. Deal what's left clockwise, one card at a time starting to the dealer's left, until every hand is exhausted.

Quick reference:

Players	Star One cards	Cards per hand
2	3	25
3	5	16
4	5	12
5	3	10
6	5	8
7	4	7

THE PLAY

- The player to the dealer's left leads any card to the first trick.
- Each player, in turn, **must follow the suit led if able**, except Vila (the Joker), who may be played to any trick regardless of suit. If unable to follow suit, a player may play any card from their hand —

this is the moment to "sluff" a dangerous Spade or Club onto someone else's trick.

- **Highest card of the suit led wins the trick.** There is no trump suit, and a wild Vila played off-suit cannot win the trick himself.
 - **Important:** the winner of a trick captures **all cards played to it**, not just their own — including any Spades or Clubs an opponent dumped into it, and including any Diamond or Joker powers, which trigger for whoever wins the trick, regardless of who actually played the card.
 - **The winner of a trick always leads the next one.** No card or power changes this — except the Andromedan Invasion, which can take the lead away from everyone. See below.
 - The trick winner gathers the cards face-down into their **Capture Pile**.
 - Play continues until every hand is empty, or until the Ace of Clubs is captured — whichever comes first.
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ENDING A MISSION EARLY: STAR ONE

If the Ace of Clubs is captured, the Federation has located Star One, and the Mission ends at once. Stop play immediately. Score the Mission using only what's already in each player's Capture Pile — cards still in hand score nothing for anyone, good or bad.

This makes the Ace of Clubs a genuine double-edged card: capturing it late, while sitting on a strong pile, locks in your lead. Being forced to capture it early, before you've built a pile, can be ruinous.

STAR ONE: RESERVE POWERS

The Reserve isn't just removed from play — it's a prize, sitting on the table for the entire Mission until someone claims it, locks it away, or is forced to take it whether they want it or not. Three cards interact with it directly:

1. The Full Crew — Ace of Hearts + any Hearts face card (capture-triggered, optional). The instant both the Ace of Hearts and at least one Hearts face card (Jack, Queen, or King) are sitting together in your Capture Pile, you may turn the Reserve face-up and take **any or all** of its cards into your Capture Pile, scoring their points along with everything else you've captured. You may also leave any you don't want face-down and out of the Mission for good. This triggers only once per Mission, the first moment the condition is met.

2. Queen of Diamonds — Destroy Star One (capture-triggered, optional). The instant you capture this card, you may choose to destroy the Reserve outright. Its cards are set aside, locked, and removed from the Mission — unscored, and unreachable by any other power (including the Full Crew, above) for the rest of the Mission. Decide immediately upon capture; once destroyed, it's gone for good.

3. King of Spades (Travis) — Seizes It (capture-triggered, mandatory). The instant you capture this card, if the Reserve still has cards in it and hasn't been destroyed, you **must** take all of them into your Capture Pile and score their points exactly as printed — good or bad, no choice in the matter. Travis doesn't ask permission.

Resolution order: These trigger in whatever order their cards are actually captured during play — there's no fixed sequence. If the Reserve has already been partly or fully claimed, or destroyed, by the time a later trigger comes up, only whatever's left (if anything) is affected. An empty or destroyed Reserve has nothing left to give, take, or lock away.

THE ANDROMEDAN INVASION

Whatever's coming through the gap you left open, it didn't knock.

The Reserve doesn't have to be dealt with all at once — but the less of it gets dealt with, the closer the invasion creeps.

The trigger: After every trick during normal play, compare two numbers — how many cards are left in each player's hand, and how many cards are still sitting unclaimed in the Reserve right now. The

moment those two numbers match, and the Reserve isn't empty, the Andromedans arrive. If the Reserve ever reaches 0 cards first — fully claimed by the Full Crew, seized by Travis, or destroyed by the Queen of Diamonds — **the Andromedans never come**, and the rest of the Mission plays out completely normally.

Example: In a five-player game with a starting Reserve of 3, if nothing has touched it, the invasion begins the moment every hand is down to 3 cards — giving it exactly 3 waves, enough to fill out the rest of the Mission. If the Full Crew had already claimed 2 of those 3 cards earlier in play, only 1 card would remain, and the invasion wouldn't begin until hands were down to 1 — a single, final wave.

Once triggered, the Andromedan leads every remaining trick of the Mission. Turn its next unclaimed Reserve card face-up — that's its lead, and it sets the required suit. Real players respond exactly as in a normal trick, following suit if able or sluffing if not, using the cards still in their hand. Highest card of the suit led, Andromedan included, wins the trick as usual, and the winner captures everything played to it, scored normally.

- **If a real player wins, that wave is repelled**, and the Andromedan leads its next card for the following trick.
- **If the Andromedan wins any wave, the invasion succeeds.** The Mission ends immediately and **nobody scores any points for it**. Move straight to the next Mission.

The invasion can be broken from the inside — by the same three cards that already interact with the Reserve, described above:

- **Capturing the Ace of Clubs** ends the Mission immediately, even mid-invasion, exactly as it does at any other point in the game. Scoring proceeds normally for whatever's already in everyone's Capture Pile — a different outcome from the Andromedan winning a wave.
- **Capturing Travis (King of Spades)** forces the seizure of whatever's left of the Reserve — and mid-invasion, "what's left" means whatever the Andromedan hasn't led yet. Take it, and the Andromedan has nothing left to lead. The invasion is over, and **the**

player who captured Travis leads the next trick — play and scoring continue normally from there.

- **Completing the Full Crew** (Ace of Hearts plus any Hearts face card) lets you claim any or all of the Reserve the instant it happens — including, mid-invasion, whatever the Andromedan hasn't led yet. Only claiming **all** of what's left ends the invasion; leave even one card behind and the Andromedan leads it next wave as usual. Clear it out entirely and **you lead the next trick** — same as with Travis, the player who shuts the invasion down earns the lead.

If every Reserve card is led and beaten without the Andromedan ever winning, the invasion is fully repelled, and the Mission proceeds straight to scoring.

SCORING

If the Mission ended because the Andromedan won an invasion wave, there's nothing to score — skip straight to the next Mission. Otherwise, score the Mission by working through these steps, in order:

Step 1 — Gauda Prime. Look at each player's Capture Pile. If a pile is non-empty and contains nothing but numbered cards ranked 2 through 10 — and every single one of those cards is a prime number (2, 3, 5, or 7) — Gauda Prime happens. The instant it triggers, every Heart card sitting in any Capture Pile at the table, including the triggering player's own, is cancelled: none of them score this Mission. The cards stay exactly where they are; only the points are gone. If more than one player happens to qualify at once, it makes no difference — the effect only needs to happen once.

Step 2 — The Mutoid Needs Serum. A Mutoid's body no longer runs on anything as simple as food — she needs a biochemical serum, a blood substitute, just to keep functioning, and draws it through the needle built into her own arm. If the Jack of Spades (Mutoid) is in a player's Capture Pile, that player must choose one Heart card from their own pile for her to drain — it scores 0 this Mission, no matter what. This is mandatory if they hold any Hearts; if their Capture Pile has no Hearts

left in it (including any already wiped by Gauda Prime, above), there's nothing for her to take, and no further effect occurs.

Step 3 — IMIPAK. If IMIPAK (10 of Diamonds) and at least one other 10 (Gan, Dayna Mellanby, or Anna Grant) are both in a player's Capture Pile, that player may choose to assassinate one card of their choice from **any player's** Capture Pile, including their own — it scores 0 this Mission. This is entirely optional. If more than one player has the combo active, resolve each player's choice in turn, starting with whoever is seated to the dealer's left.

Step 4 — Totals. Each player adds up the point values of every card remaining in their Capture Pile. Any card cancelled by Orac, devoured by the Mutoid, assassinated by IMIPAK, or wiped by Gauda Prime scores 0.

Step 5 — The Psycho-Strategist's Gambit. If both the King of Clubs (Carnell) and the Ace of Spades (Servalan) are in the same player's Capture Pile, that player's entire Mission total is flipped — positive becomes negative, negative becomes positive, same magnitude either way. (A total of exactly 0 has nothing to flip.) This is not optional, and the player holding both cards has no say in it once it applies.

Record the running total for each player.

Play one Mission per player, so the dealer's seat has gone all the way around the table once, then total all scores. **Highest total wins.**

Tie-breaker: play one additional Mission, "The Final Run" — sudden death, highest single-Mission score wins outright.

A WORKED EXAMPLE OF A TRICK

Four players: Vargas, Ensor, Coser, and Zeeona, seated clockwise in that order, with Vargas about to lead.

- **Vargas leads the 9♥.** Worth +9 if captured.
- **Ensor** follows with the **A♥ (Avon, +10)** — currently winning.
- **Coser**, unable to follow Hearts, sluffs the **K♠ (Travis, -10)** — a calculated risk, hoping someone else wins.

- **Zeeona**, also out of Hearts, sluffs the **A♦ (Orac, +5, with power)**.

Ensor's Ace of Hearts is the highest Heart played, so **Ensor wins the trick** and captures all four cards: 9♥, A♥, K♠, and A♦.

Ensor's net from this trick: $+9 (9♥) + 10 (A♥) - 10 (K♠) + 5 (A♦) = +14$ **points**, and Ensor now gets to use Orac's power — cancelling the K♠'s -10, turning this trick into a **+24 swing**. Coser's gamble to sluff Travis backfired badly; Ensor leads the next trick.

STRATEGY NOTES

- **Don't lead into Hearts early** unless you're confident you can win the trick — handing Blake or Avon to an opponent is a gift.
- **Sluff Spades and Clubs onto tricks you're sure you'll lose**, especially early, before opponents have built piles big enough to absorb the damage comfortably.
- **The Ace of Spades (Servalan) is the single worst card in the game** — track who's still holding Spades, and never lead a Spade you can't afford to lose if you're forced to follow.
- **The Mutoid (Jack of Spades) bites back at scoring time, not during the trick.** Capturing her costs you -10 *and* one of your own Hearts at the end of the Mission — so a big pile of rescued crew isn't fully safe just because the trick is over. If you're stuck with her, you at least get to choose which Heart she takes.
- **Diamonds are quietly powerful.** Zen's information power won't get you out of a bad spot directly, but knowing exactly what an opponent is holding makes every decision after it sharper — especially when deciding whether to chase the Full Crew or play it safe.
- **The Reserve is a battlefield of its own.** Watch for the Full Crew combo building in anyone's pile (Ace of Hearts plus a face card), and consider whether the Queen of Diamonds is worth more to you destroying the Reserve than scoring it normally. If Travis (King of Spades) is still loose, remember that whoever takes him doesn't get a choice about what comes with him.

- **Watch the Ace of Clubs.** If your Capture Pile is weak, you don't want to be the one who triggers Star One. If your pile is strong, scooping it up early can end the Mission before opponents recover.
 - **Carnell and Servalan together flip your whole Mission score.** If you're already deep in the negative, deliberately chasing both can be a real comeback play — flip a bad Mission into a great one. But if you're sitting on a strong positive pile, treat both cards as radioactive: together they can undo an entire Mission's work in a single trick, and once you've got them both, there's no taking it back.
 - **Watch the gap between your hand and the Reserve.** If nobody's touched Star One by the time hands get small, the invasion is coming whether you're ready or not — and once it starts, you can't lead, you can only respond. Clearing the Reserve early, by any of the three means available, is the only way to control when (or whether) the Andromedan ever shows up.
 - **IMIPAK only works if you've already got a matching 10.** Holding it alone does nothing — you need Gan, Dayna, or Anna Grant sitting in the same pile before it's worth anything. Once it's live, it can hit anyone's Capture Pile, not just yours — save it for whoever's sitting on the biggest score at the table, not just your own worst card.
 - **Gauda Prime is rare, but it's worth knowing the shape of it.** An all-prime, all-numbered Capture Pile (only 2s, 3s, 5s, and 7s, nothing else) wipes every Heart at the table, including your own. It's not something to chase deliberately — but if you notice your pile drifting that way, think twice before sweeping in a Jack just to be safe.
 - **Dayna is the one good card hiding in a bad suit.** Everything else in Clubs is a small penalty, but she's worth +10 — so don't treat every Club the same way. If you can tell she's still loose, it's worth fighting to be the one who captures that particular trick.
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APPENDIX: WHO'S WHO

A quick reference for anyone new to the setting, organized by suit.

The Liberator Crew (Hearts)

- **Blake (King)** — Roj Blake, the escaped political prisoner whose name the rebellion carries. *First appears S1E01, "The Way Back."*
- **Avon (Ace)** — Kerr Avon, a brilliant, self-interested computer expert who keeps the crew alive through pragmatism more than loyalty. *First appears S1E02, "Spacefall."*
- **Cally (Jack)** — A telepathic survivor of a resistance movement crushed on her own homeworld, who joins the crew after Blake's first escape. *First appears S1E04, "Time Squad."*
- **Jenna (Queen)** — Jenna Stannis, the crew's pilot: a former smuggler with sharp instincts and sharper reflexes. *First appears S1E01, "The Way Back."*
- **Gan (10)** — Olag Gan, a gentle giant fitted with a neural limiter that prevents him from ever killing again. *First appears S1E03, "Cygnus Alpha."*
- **Vila (Joker)** — Vila Restal, a self-described coward and the best thief in the system, talked into the rebellion more than he ever volunteered for it. *First appears S1E01, "The Way Back."*

Technology (Diamonds)

- **Orac (Ace)** — A temperamental supercomputer capable of accessing nearly any data system in the galaxy, when it feels like cooperating. *First appears S1E13, "Orac."*
- **Liberator (Queen)** — The crew's ship: alien-built, blindingly fast, and not entirely understood even by the people flying it. *First appears S1E02, "Spacefall."*
- **Zen (King)** — The Liberator's own onboard intelligence: cryptic, occasionally unhelpful, fiercely protective of its ship. *First appears S1E02, "Spacefall."*
- **IMIPAK (10)** — a failsafe assassination weapon: implant a trigger in a target, then detonate it from anywhere, anytime. *First appears S2E03, "Weapon."*

- **Teleport Bracelet (Jack)** — standard crew equipment, not a person: the device that lets the crew beam down to (and escape from) hostile worlds at a moment's notice. *First appears S1E02, "Spacefall."*

The Federation (Spades)

- **Servalan (Ace)** — Supreme Commander of the Federation, equally comfortable ordering a massacre or hosting a diplomatic reception. *First appears S1E06, "Seek-Locate-Destroy."*
- **Travis (King)** — A Federation Space Commander turned obsessive hunter, fixated on capturing or killing Blake at any cost. *First appears S1E06, "Seek-Locate-Destroy."*
- **Mutoid (Jack)** — A Federation soldier surgically and chemically altered into something closer to a weapon than a person. *First mentioned S1E06, "Seek-Locate-Destroy."*
- **Anna Grant (10)** — A name from Avon's past, eventually revealed to be something far more dangerous than it first appeared. *First appears S3E08, "Rumours of Death."*
- **Section Leader (Queen) / Federation Trooper (2-9)** — generic Federation personnel: replaceable, and largely interchangeable to their own command structure. *No single first appearance — they're everywhere, by design.*

Hazards & Adversaries (Clubs)

- **Carnell, the Psycho-Strategist (King)** — Servalan's tactician, who studies people closely enough to turn their own plans back against them. *First appears S2E03, "Weapon."*
- **Dayna Mellanby (10)** — A weapons specialist who joins the crew later in their fight, with a personal preference for blades and explosives over Federation tech — which is why her card sits in Clubs despite scoring well for whoever holds it. *First appears S3E01, "Aftermath."*
- **Star One (Ace)** — see *The Setting*, above: the Federation's hidden communications nexus, and the thing this entire game keeps circling. *First named S2E13, "Star One."*

- **System Failure (Jack) / Asteroid Field (Queen)** — the ordinary, unglamorous dangers of deep space, with no single face behind them. *No single first appearance.*

Key Locations

- **Gauda Prime** — a remote frontier world, and the site of the rebellion's final, bloody reckoning. *First appears S4E13, "Blake."*

Beyond the Federation

- **The Andromedan** — an alien intelligence from beyond the galaxy's edge, with no interest whatsoever in the Federation's wars — only in what's left once they're finished fighting them. *First appears S2E13, "Star One."*

"You may not have noticed, but the Federation has a long memory."